Cybersecurity Safeguards

Junior Cybersecurity Badge — Girls Build Bots

Presented by your robotics mentors!

You can protect yourself 💪

Last time: how information travels.

Today: the **practical protections** you'll actually use.

The message is "you can protect yourself" — not "the internet is scary."

Rule #1, out loud 📢

Every password today is made up.

Never write down or share a **real** password.

Not with your friends. Not with a grown-up. **Not with us.**

Password Strength Lab 🔬

Sort these made-up passwords weakest → strongest.
What patterns do you see?

The rules you just discovered 🔑

- **Longer beats clever** 📏
- **Mixed characters** help
- A **passphrase** — three random words — is strong *and* memorable

`PurpleRobotTaco!`

Your turn: invent your own passphrase with the method.

The second lock 🔒 🔒

Some accounts send a code to a grown-up's phone.
That's called **two-factor**.

Two locks beat one.

Spot the Phish 🎣

Here's your "inbox." For each message, hunt for **red flags**:

- ⏰ Urgent pressure — "act NOW!"
- 🎁 Prizes for nothing
- 🔤 Misspelled sender addresses
- 🔗 Links that don't match their label
- 🔑 Requests for personal info or passwords

The rule of thumb 👍

Real companies don’t ask for your password in a message.

Unsure? **Don’t click. Ask a trusted adult.**

Footprints in the Sand 👣

For each scenario card, ask three questions:

1. **Who can see this?**
2. **How long does it last?**
3. **Would you want it visible in five years?**

Things shared online can **persist and travel**.

Safeguard: think before you post, and set privacy settings with a grown-up.

Robot moment 

Our team protects its accounts and code with strong passphrases, and we **never share logins**.

Losing control of the robot's code would be a very bad day.

My Safeguard Kit 

Write your personal **top three**:

1. A passphrase method
2. A phishing red flag you'll watch for
3. A think-before-posting rule

Then quiz a partner: **phish, or legit?**

What you accomplished ✅

- Explained what makes a password strong, and built a passphrase
- Spotted at least three phishing red flags
- Explained what a digital footprint is and why it lasts
- Named your personal top-three safeguards

Keep going at home! 🏠

- **beinternetawesome.withgoogle.com** — Tower of Treasure (free)
- Teach your passphrase method to someone at home
- Ask your troop leader about the next Cybersecurity badge!

📣 Share Your Impact

Troop leaders & robotics teams — if you used this curriculum, please:

1. **Credit us** — the curriculum comes from **Girls Build Bots**
2. **Tag us** — **@girlsbuildbots** on Instagram
3. **Report your results** — email **girlsbuildbots@gmail.com** with how many girls took part, how many badges were earned, and how it went

This is how the program grows — and how the next troop and team get better materials.